

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1435

By Faison

A RESOLUTION to commend and honor Chief Sergeant-at-Arms
Bobby Trotter on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should pay special tribute to those estimable legislative employees whose commitment to excellence and dedication to public service have brought untold benefits to the citizens of the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Bobby Trotter, who is taking his much-deserved retirement after a distinguished career with the Tennessee House of Representatives, where he has served in the position of Sergeant-at Arms; and

WHEREAS, Bobby Washington Trotter was born on February 13, 1951; he graduated from Bradford High School in 1968 and attended Draughon's Business College (now Daymar College); and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trotter has always loved being around and being in service to others; one of his first jobs was as a life guard at a local swimming pool, teaching children safety rules and the importance of doing the right thing; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trotter was a Tennessee Highway Patrol Road Trooper from 1974 to 1986, at which time he was assigned to Governor Ned McWherter's security detail, a post he held until 1994; he later served as part of the security detail for Governor Don Sundquist; and

WHEREAS, in 2001, Bobby Trotter became captain of the Tennessee State Capitol and Legislature Security Detail and served in that capacity until his retirement in 2008; since that time, he has served as Sergeant-at-Arms for the Tennessee House of Representatives, and since 2019, he has served as Chief Sergeant-at-Arms; and

WHEREAS, devoted to serving his community, Mr. Trotter was elected as Springfield Ward 2 Alderman in 2014, earning reelection to that position in 2018 and 2022; and

WHEREAS, during his lifetime, Bobby Trotter has had the opportunity to meet and assist Rosa Parks; attend two presidential inaugurations and inaugural balls as well as both Democratic and Republican National Conventions; and shake hands with five U.S. Presidents: Ronald Reagan, Jimmy Carter, Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, and Barack Obama; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many personal accomplishments and achievements, Bobby Trotter has been supported by his beloved wife, Ruth; the Trotters are proud parents of two daughters, Tasha and the late Tamara, and doting grandparents; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trotter is an exemplary citizen who epitomizes the ideal of the consummate professional, dedicated public servant, and reliable friend and neighbor; and

WHEREAS, clearly deserving of our respect, admiration, and commendation, Bobby Trotter has distinguished himself as a public servant of the highest order and should be specially recognized on this momentous occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Chief Sergeant-at-Arms Bobby Trotter and extend to him our deepest appreciation for his meritorious service to the State of Tennessee and the General Assembly. We extend to him our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.